When Nabamita Bhattacharya and her husband, Sattam, left behind a comfortable life in London to return to Kolkata in 2013, it was not for career prospects, but for family. Their ageing parents needed them close. The decision would quietly plant the seed for a venture that, years later, would bridge similar distances for many others.

In 2020, as the pandemic sharpened the isolation of the elderly, Sattam voiced an idea to his wife: what if there were a service that could stand in for adult children who lived far away? Nabamita, a former HR professional, was immediately on board.



Sattam introduced Nabamita to his old schoolmate, Sanjeev Khona, who in turn brought in his wife, Sangita—both Calcutta University alumni with combined expertise in sales, distribution, customer relations and service delivery. And so Buddy Back Home Private Limited was born, with a shared purpose: to offer not just a service, but a bond of trust between the elderly and their caregivers.

Today, the three co-founders run a tightly organised operation. Nabamita, a company director, oversees training, human resources and the in-house clinic; Sanjeev manages marketing; Sangita, also a director, handles daily operations. Their "buddies", as they call the staff, are more than attendants—they are companions, problem-solvers and lifelines for the company's 300-plus member families.

The model is deceptively simple: care plans tailored to each family's needs, from occasional visits to twice-weekly check-ins, all underpinned by 24/7 emergency support. The menu of services is expansive. Buddies might help with groceries one day and manage hospital admissions the next. A panel of 40 doctors supports preventive and urgent care, while a team of seven lawyers stands ready for members who need legal intervention.

From its base in Kolkata, Buddy Back Home has expanded to North and South 24 Parganas, Howrah, Hooghly and even Siliguri. It employs 30 full-time staff, 25 of them women, and prides itself on having retained every single employee since its inception.

In a city near-synonymous with out-migration of the young, where many parents are left to navigate ageing alone, the venture fills a void that is as much emotional as it is practical. "We offer 360-degree care," Nabamita says. "Other eldercare providers usually stop at medical services. We go beyond, making sure everything our member needs is taken care of."

Buddy Back Home's promise is not one of replacing family, but of extending it—of ensuring that when distance makes presence impossible, there is still someone to rely on. In the quiet relief of a hospital corridor, in the completion of an urgent bank errand, in the steady companionship of a familiar face, the company's work is measured not only in revenue but in reassurance. For a city bound by tradition but shaped by migration, that reassurance is priceless. ■

FACT SHEET

Name of company
Buddy Back Home

What they do
A comprehensive elder care service

Founded in: 2020

Co-founder
Sanjeev Khona, 55, Marketing head

Annual turnover
Rs 1.25 crore

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>
> **NABAMITA BHATTACHARYA**